Table 49. Planning assumptions for the indicative budget

Item	Assumption	Basis
Exchange rate	Tk 124 per US dollar	Bangladesh Bank weighted average rate of Tk 123.65 on 19 October 2026 [113]
Core staff	9, 15 and 19 full-time equivalents in Years 1, 2 and 3	Staffing plan (Table 16)
Year 1 recruitment	75% of Year 1 positions filled on average	Director appointed in months 1 to 3; other posts filled in months 2 to 6 (Section 15.4)
Staff cost	Fully loaded monthly cost per FTE at Year 1 prices: Director Tk 3.0 lakh; ML and Bangla NLP engineers Tk 2.0 lakh; security engineer Tk 1.8 lakh; policy, data and platform staff Tk 1.5 lakh; governance and UX staff Tk 1.25 lakh; coordinator Tk 0.9 lakh; training officers Tk 0.8 lakh	Above the basic pay of the Ninth National Pay Scale 2026 (Tk 20,000 to Tk 156,000 a month; Tk 44,000 at grade 9, the entry grade for BCS officers), approved by the Cabinet in August 2026 [106], to compete for scarce AI skills. Reported market pay for AI and ML engineers in Dhaka: Tk 0.7 to 1.1 lakh a month at mid level and Tk 1.2 to 2.0 lakh at senior level, before provident fund and bonuses [105]
Escalation	8% a year on taka costs in Years 2 and 3	Point-to-point inflation of 8.34% in September 2026, as reported [114]; the host's increment rules may differ
Language editors and fellows	Part-time editors Tk 12 to 14 lakh a year; 6, 10 and 12 fellows at Tk 40,000 a month (Year 1 prices)	Fellowship programme (Section 6.6); the stipend equals the PhD fellowship of a public university [107]
Equipment	General-purpose servers USD 12,000 each; GPU inference servers (L40S class) USD 25,000 each; storage USD 6,000 to 12,000 a year	L40S card about USD 7,100 (lowest marketplace average, September 2026) to USD 8,050 (retail listing) [109, 110]: two cards and a GPU-capable host of about USD 10,000 make one inference server. Dell list price of a base two-socket server about USD 16,000 in August 2026 [111]; memory prices rose sharply in 2025 and 2026 [112]. At list prices equipment costs about 26% more, about Tk 0.7 crore (Section 17.1)
Import duty and VAT on equipment	Not included in the base case; 25% added in the high scenario	Depends on the host's exemption status; input required from the host's procurement office
Hosting and operations	Tk 25 lakh rising to Tk 38 lakh a year (Year 1 prices)	Colocation of one standard 2 to 7 kW rack in a domestic facility about Tk 1.0 to 1.6 lakh a month, as reported in July 2026 [108]; the balance covers bandwidth, licences and a development cloud, and a second (disaster-recovery) site from Year 2
Model adaptation compute	In kind from shared national compute; USD 20,000 of cloud GPU time on public (DC0) data in the high scenario	Table 31; draft national AI policy [12]; cloud prices in [115]
Benchmark and evaluation data	2,000 answerable questions by month 30 at Tk 2,500; 300 out-of-scope questions at Tk 600; 2,000 citation-support judgements at Tk 500	BanglaPolicyQA plan (Section 9.4); evaluation protocol (Annex R)
Training	500 officials by month 36 at Tk 15,000 per participant, plus specialist courses	Training curriculum (Table 18)
Evaluation and assurance	Legal review Tk 8 lakh; baseline study Tk 6 lakh; mid-term evaluation Tk 20 lakh; final evaluation Tk 25 lakh; annual penetration test and red team Tk 6 lakh; annual independent audit of systems Tk 3 lakh	Chapters 13, 14 and 18
Host overheads	10% of direct costs	To be confirmed against the host institution's policy
Contingency	5% of direct costs in the base case, released only by Steering Board decision; 10% recommended until quotations and the host's rates are known (adjusted base case and high scenario)	Allowance for estimating uncertainty; scenarios in Annex Q

Planning assumptions for the Phase 0 costing study (Section 15.1), not quotations. The model is published as blueprint/src/budget_model.py so that any assumption can be changed and the budget regenerated.

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